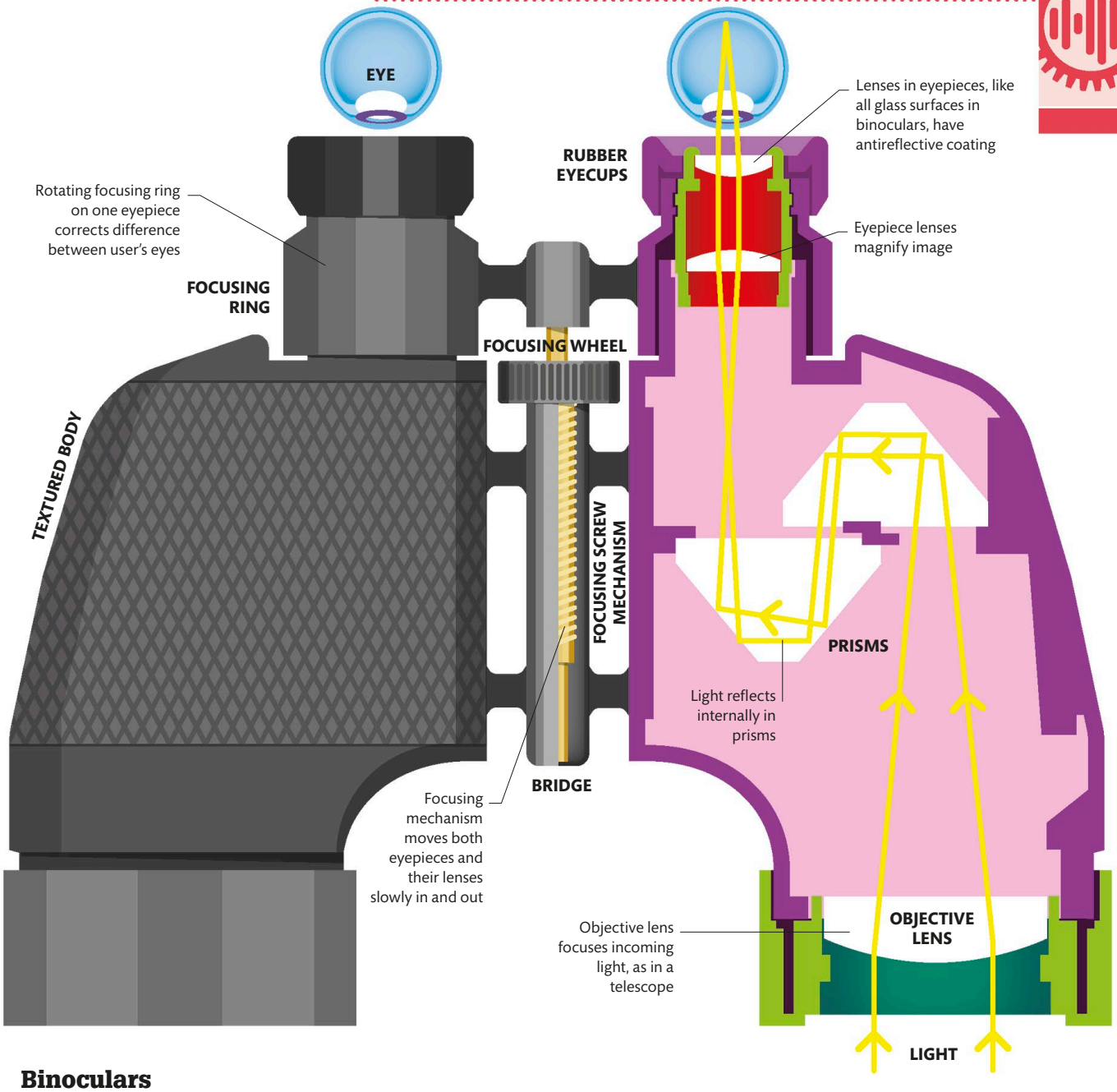


Binoculars

Binoculars consist of two refracting telescopes side by side—one for each eye. Two glass prisms in each tube turn the image the right way around and make it possible to have objective lenses with a long focal length in a short tube, by bending light back on itself twice. The smaller size makes binoculars easy to carry around, and the two eyepieces make for comfortable viewing.

THE LARGEST OBJECTIVE LENS IN A REFRACTING TELESCOPE IS 40 IN (102 CM) IN DIAMETER. IT IS IN THE YERKES OBSERVATORY